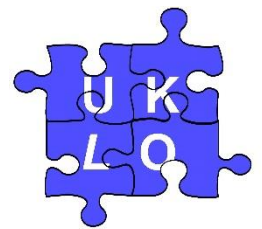


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Round 2 Problem 4. Muddled hieroglyphs

Why was it so hard to work out how Egyptian hieroglyphs worked? Here's a taste of the complexities in the system, which explain why it was such a leap forward not only when Champollion deciphered the hieroglyphs in 1822, but even more impressively when the Phoenicians developed their alphabet out of the hieroglyphic system. The Egyptian system was extremely complicated because there were eventually 5,000 different 'glyphs' (shapes) which were combined in complicated and inconsistent ways to represent words. Each hieroglyph-pattern might combine glyphs relating to its meaning, to its grammar, and/or to its pronunciation.

The first table illustrates all the main possibilities for relating a **hieroglyph-pattern** (in the first column) to a **word** (defined by pronunciation and meaning in the second and third columns).

	/yw/	is
	/nfr/	happily
	/nfr/	good, beautiful
	/nfrt/	cows

You will notice that the pronunciations in the second column don't include any vowels; this is because, although Egyptian (like every other language) had vowels in speech, the vowels weren't shown in the writing so we can't show them either. (There are many different 'transliteration' systems for hieroglyphs, most of which use our vowel symbols to show special Egyptian consonants; the system used here is an adaptation to show the lack of vowels more clearly.) In the following data, /3/ indicates a non-English consonant produced in the back of the throat.

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Q.4. The tables below show more words written in hieroglyphs, but although the words in the second table (A-N) pair pronunciations and meanings correctly, the tables don't show how the words are paired with the hieroglyph-patterns (1-14) in the first table. The challenge for you is to work out this pairing and enter it in the answer sheet. Only 13 of the hieroglyph patterns can be correctly paired, so you will have one hieroglyph pattern and one word left over.

1		2		3	
4		5		6	
7		8		9	
10		11		12	
13		14		15	
16					

A	/hmt/	female slave	B	/nw/	gifts	C	/pr/	house
D	/hm/	male slave	E	/pr3/	palace	F	/pr3/	pharaoh
G	/hmntr/	priest	H	/hmntr/	priestess	I	/prt/	procession
J	/prt/	seed	K	/pr/	to go out	L	/hms/	to sit down
M	/prt/	winter-season	N	/hmt/	woman	O	/htpt/	offerings
P	/htpntr/	divine offerings						

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Problem 2.4 Muddled hieroglyphs (answer blank)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16